Who's in Charge Here?

AP Human Geography · Unit 4 · No stimulus (like Question 1) · 7 points · Teacher key · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

No stimulus. Every government claims a piece of the Earth's surface, but who holds power over it depends on scale: international organizations, national governments, regions, and city councils can all claim a say over the same ground.

A. Define the concept of territoriality in terms of political geography. DEFINE

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ANY ONE OF THESE:

- Says people or groups try to claim, control, or defend a specific area
- Says people feel attached to, connected to, or identify with a specific area

MODEL ANSWER

Territoriality is the connection of people, their culture, and their economy to a specific piece of land, shown when they try to claim, defend, and control that territory.

Common mistake: “Territoriality is the land that a country owns.” That defines territory, not territoriality. Add the human part: people's attachment to the land and their effort to control it.

Why the model works: It starts with the term and has both halves: a connection to a specific piece of land and the effort to control it.

B. Describe the concept of sovereignty as it relates to the state. DESCRIBE

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Says what it is: a state's authority to govern its territory
- Describes the independence: no outside interference

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Sovereignty is a state's supreme authority to govern its own territory and people without interference from other states.
E2- A sovereign state like Japan makes its own laws, controls its borders, prints its own money, and signs treaties, and other countries recognize that right.
A3- Sovereignty is what makes a place a true state: Puerto Rico has its own government but is not sovereign, because the U.S. Congress has the final say over it.

Common mistake: “Sovereignty is when a country has a government.” Cities have governments too. Describe what makes a state sovereign: it rules its own territory with no outside interference.

Why the model works: It describes sovereignty (self-rule without outside interference), proves it with Japan's powers, and contrasts Puerto Rico.

C. Compare ONE difference between unitary states and federal states. COMPARE

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Unitary side: the central government holds most of the power (e.g., France, Japan, China)
- Federal side: power is shared with states or provinces (e.g., the U.S., Germany, India, Canada)

MODEL ANSWER

T1- In a unitary state the central government holds most of the power, while in a federal state power is shared between the national government and states or provinces.
E2- For example, in unitary France the national government in Paris sets most policy, including one national school curriculum, while in the federal United States each of the 50 states makes many of its own laws, like speed limits.
A3- This matters because a federal system lets a large, diverse country give regions control over local issues, while a unitary system keeps laws the same nationwide.

Common mistake: "A federal state shares power between the national government and the states." That's only half of a comparison. Add the unitary side: in a unitary state, the central government holds most of the power.

Why the model works: It states the difference for BOTH types (central vs. shared power), gives an example of each (France, the U.S.), and explains why it matters.

D. Explain ONE possible reason why sovereignty played a role in the UK's withdrawal from the EU. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names what the UK felt it had lost: control of laws, borders, trade, or courts
- Explains the link: the UK wanted to take back control from the EU

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Sovereignty played a role because many British voters felt EU membership took away the UK's power to make its own decisions.
E2- As an EU member, the UK had to follow EU laws, accept free movement of EU citizens across its borders, and follow rulings of the European Court of Justice, so the Leave campaign promised to "take back control."
A3- Because many voters wanted Parliament, not the EU, to control the UK's laws and borders, about 52% voted to leave in June 2016, and the UK left the EU on January 31, 2020.

Common mistake: "The UK left the EU because people voted for Brexit." That says what happened, not why. Name what the UK wanted control over (laws, borders, trade) and how leaving gave it back.

Why the model works: It names what voters felt the UK had lost (laws, borders, courts), gives proof (free movement, the European Court of Justice), and explains how that led to leaving.

E. Explain ONE possible reason why territoriality would play a role in devolution. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names the territorial link: a group's attachment to its homeland or region
- Explains the result: demands for self-rule, autonomy, or independence

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Territoriality can lead to devolution because a group deeply attached to its homeland wants to control that territory itself.
E2- For example, many Scots see Scotland as a distinct nation with its own history and identity, so they pushed for self-rule, and in 1999 the UK opened a Scottish Parliament with power over schools, health care, and policing.
A3- Because people want decisions about their land made in their own region, not a distant capital, this attachment pressures the national government to devolve power.

Common mistake: "Devolution is when the central government gives power to regions." A correct definition, but it skips territoriality. Explain how a group's attachment to its homeland makes it push for power.

Why the model works: It links territoriality (attachment to a homeland) to devolution (demands for self-rule) and proves it with Scotland.

F. Explain how redrawing district boundary lines may affect election results within a city. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names HOW: packing, cracking, splitting or combining neighborhoods, or a majority-minority district
- Explains the effect on results: which group, party, or candidate wins council seats

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Redrawing district lines can change which group wins seats on a city council, even if no one changes how they vote.
E2- For example, if a Latino neighborhood with enough voters to control one district is cracked, or split among three districts, its voters become a minority in each and may elect no council member at all.
A3- Because votes only count inside each district, where the lines fall decides whether a group's votes add up to a win or get wasted.

Common mistake: "Redrawing district lines can change the election because the districts are different." That repeats the question. Explain HOW: cracking splits a neighborhood's voters so they're outnumbered and lose seats.

Why the model works: It names the effect (who wins seats), gives a mechanism (cracking a neighborhood three ways), and explains why lines matter.

G. Explain why neighboring local governments may face challenges providing transportation services in a growing metro area. EXPLAIN

EARNS THE POINT IF THE ANSWER DOES ALL OF THESE:

- Names the cause: fragmentation into many separate governments
- Explains the effect: fights over who pays, or routes that stop at boundaries

MODEL ANSWER

T1- Neighboring governments may struggle to provide transportation because a growing metro area is politically fragmented into many separate cities and counties, each with its own budget and priorities.
E2- For example, in 2019 suburban Gwinnett County voted not to join Atlanta's MARTA system, so MARTA trains still don't reach the county.
A3- Because no single government runs the whole metro, governments argue over who should pay, and bus and rail routes stop at city or county lines, leaving commuters stuck in traffic as the region grows.

Common mistake: “It's hard because growing cities have a lot of traffic.” That's a problem, but not why NEIGHBORING governments struggle. Explain fragmentation: separate governments with their own budgets argue over who pays.

Why the model works: It names the cause (political fragmentation), gives a real example (Gwinnett County and MARTA), and explains the effect (funding fights).
